Javier Franco

Montevideo, Uruguay ◇ Uruguayan citizen
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Education

Universidad de la República, Facultad de Ciencias Económicas y Administración Feb. 2025 - Present
M.Sc. in Economics (Research track), joint program with Facultad de Ciencias Sociales. Montevideo, Uruguay
GPA: 3.74/4.0, highest in cohort

- Master's Thesis: *"Does Austerity Redistribute?"* Advisors: Ronald Miranda and Leonel Muinelo. Expected defense: November 2026.

Universidad de la República, Facultad de Ciencias Económicas y Administración Mar. 2021 - Dec. 2024
B.Sc. in Economics. GPA: 3.50/4.0, ranked 10th of 123. Degree conferred 2025 Montevideo, Uruguay

Fields of Interest

Development Economics · Labor Economics · Household Finance · Public Finance · Political Economy

Research Statement

I work on three lines of research at the Institute of Economics (FCEA, Universidad de la República). The first uses individual-level administrative data to follow household debt and access to credit after the household head loses their job, and asks whether the financial system cushions the income shock or makes it worse. The second, which I started more recently, is on contagious presenteeism in Uruguayan firms: whether public sick-leave subsidies, combined with firm practices that discourage absenteeism, lead workers to come in sick and infect their coworkers. The third, my master's thesis, asks who bears the cost of fiscal consolidations. With a pooled panel of OECD and Latin American and Caribbean economies, narrative consolidation episodes and local projections, I test whether the distributional effects depend more on a country's quality of government than on its region, and whether tax-based and expenditure-based adjustments still differ once state capacity is accounted for.

Research Experience

Instituto de Economía (FCEA), Universidad de la República Jul. 2025 - Present
Research Assistant. Appointed by competitive call 35 hrs/week

- Inequality and Poverty group: research assistant on *"Interest over Interests: Analysis of Uruguayan Household Debt"* (competitive grant, CSIC [Comisión Sectorial de Investigación Científica], Universidad de la República), on the effect of household-head job loss on household debt and credit access. Built the Stata pipeline linking the BCU credit registry (CRC, about 1.7 million debtors) to MTSS employer-employee records at monthly frequency, 2012-2022 (hundreds of millions of records): firm-month panels, detection of mass layoffs and closures (including firms that reopen under a new identifier), two-stage propensity score matching, and event-study estimation.
- Macroeconomic Analysis and Trade group: research assistant on *"Redistributive Efficiency of Fiscal Policy and State Capacity: A Macroeconomic Analysis Emphasizing Uruguay"* (competitive grant, CSIC). My master's thesis is part of this project: I assembled a country-year panel of 30 OECD and Latin American economies (1996-2019) from seven sources and estimated state-dependent local projections.
- Labor Economics group: research assistant on *"Contagious Presenteeism in Uruguayan Firms"*, studying how public sick-leave subsidies and firm practices that discourage absenteeism together affect the spread of contagious illness among employees. Processing of labor-history and Sickness Subsidy records.

Teaching Experience

Facultad de Ciencias Económicas y Administración, Universidad de la República Aug. 2025 - Present

Teaching Assistant, Statistics 1 10 hrs/week

- Department of Quantitative Methods. Appointed by competitive call. Responsible for practical sessions, exercise design, and course material.

Universidad Católica del Uruguay Aug. 2024 - Dec. 2024

Teaching Assistant, Econometrics 2 4 hrs/week

- Responsible for practical sessions. Developed exercises and solutions; corrected and extended course notes; created evaluation material.

Professional Experience

CPA Ferrere Jul. 2023 - Jun. 2025

Economic Analyst, Economic Analysis and Forecasting Service Montevideo, Uruguay

- Monitored and analyzed national and international macroeconomic indicators; wrote regular briefings for private-sector clients; produced short-term macroeconomic forecasts.
- Advised client firms on macroeconomic conditions; made intensive use of R, Stata, EViews, and Bloomberg for data processing, model estimation, and visualization.

Workshops and Summer Schools

- Winter School 2025 (*Jornadas Anuales de Economía: Escuela de Invierno*). Central Bank of Uruguay.
- LACEA-LAMES 2024. Universidad de la República, Uruguay.
- RIDGE Summer School 2023. Research Institute for Development, Growth and Economics / Central Bank of Uruguay.

Other Writing

- Co-author, "Finanzas departamentales en Uruguay: implicancias en la desigualdad y el desarrollo territorial" [Departmental Finances in Uruguay: Implications for Inequality and Territorial Development]. *La Diaria*, October 10, 2024. ladiaria.com.uy

Languages and Computing Skills

- **Languages:** Spanish (native), English (C2: Certificate of Proficiency in English, Cambridge Assessment English, 2020), Portuguese (intermediate: Centro de Lenguas Extranjeras, Uruguay, 2019).
- **Computing:** Stata (advanced), R, LaTeX, Git/GitHub, Python (basic), MATLAB, EViews, Bloomberg.

References

- **Rodrigo Ceni**. Associate professor, Universidad de la República. Supervisor on the household debt project (2025–present). Contact: rodrigo.ceni@fcea.edu.uy
- **Leonel Muinelo**. Full professor, Universidad de la República. Advisor of my master's thesis (with Ronald Miranda), 2025–present. Contact: leomuinelo@gmail.com